

July/August 2025 Newsletter

(1) Have your say on SHASA's website (Kat please create a QR code)

When was the last time you used SHASA's website? What should/could it be used for? Who should it be targeted to — prospective, new or existing members? Does it adequately reflect and promote SHASA's work?

SHASA is seeking your input to answer these questions to inform its Digital Strategy and an improved website.

With six years' worth of content on the website, we need to know — what should stay and what should go? Help us by answering a few quick questions about the current website at [shasa.com.au](https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSct6qo3cg7pQCPo5E-iHTai8BgScTbsMNa7LQYrrcdAjjv5Cg/viewform?usp=header) here:

<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSct6qo3cg7pQCPo5E-iHTai8BgScTbsMNa7LQYrrcdAjjv5Cg/viewform?usp=header>

(2) Home Battery Rebates — what's real, what's hype, what's in it for you? (include MESA flyer)

There's been a lot of noise lately about battery rebates, and we've had quite a few calls asking what's real, what's not, and whether you need to act now or miss out.

An unfortunate outcome when the media announces government program rebates ahead of Industry consultation is incorrect information and changes to program requirements as they get ironed out.

In our industry, it's actually the aggregators or traders who have the final word on:

a] interpreting the eligibility of equipment and the installation of that equipment for access to a rebate scheme

b] setting the final value of that rebate in relation to the equipment and its installation

At the time of writing this, the aggregators have confirmed that implementation of the **Cheaper Home Batteries Program** requires amendments to the Renewable Energy [Electricity] Regulations 2001, and as such, technical requirements associated with the program are still being developed, despite the media's announcements.

What we do know about the Scheme is it:

- will be offered nationally and cover around 30% of the upfront cost of a battery
- will now be available to both on grid and off grid customers

- will be available to installations with a minimum of 5kWh up to a maximum of 50kWh, and based on the useable capacity of a battery
- only batteries with listing approved by the scheme and installed by a licenced electrician accredited for battery storage with Solar Accreditation Australia will be eligible
- the battery needs to be compatible with Virtual Power Plant [VPP] interface, however inclusion in a VPP arrangement with a retailer is not mandatory
- will decrease in rebate value each year until 2030, in the same way the Federal Government's Small-scale Technology Scheme works for panels

In our experience there is no need to rush or panic buy, you do not need to grab all the toilet paper off the supermarket shelf right now to ensure your bottom line is safe [so to speak]. There are plenty of batteries to go round and plenty of time to have them installed. We recommend first determining if a home battery is feasible for you.

Warm regards,

Stephen & Lisa *Micro Energy Systems Australia (MESA)*

(3) Information session to learn more

Due to the volume of enquiries, **Repurposing for Resilience Eurobodalla, Inc.** will be hosting an information session at the Community Solar Reuse Centre on Saturday 26 July. This is an ideal opportunity to learn exactly what's on offer with the battery rebate and how it can work best for you. The session will also cover electric vehicle charging.

Participants are encouraged to bring along a recent copy of their energy bill and image of their meter box/switchboard. Details below:

When: Saturday 26 July; 10.30am - 12.30pm

Where: RfR Community Solar Reuse Centre; Moruya Transfer Station - 21 Yarragee Road Moruya

Cost: \$5 for RfR members or \$10 for non members; cash and card options available.

Café facilities with espresso coffee will be available

(4) RfR Community Workshops 2025

rfeurobodalla@gmail.com or call 0499 864 970 www.rfeurobodalla.com.au

WEAVING FROM WASTE; workshop transforming discarded textiles, strings and plastics into woven masterpieces. Suitable for complete beginners or seasoned weavers. BYO lunch, coffee provided. Cost: Free	1st and 3rd Saturday of every month 10am-2pm HAZEL HOFFMAN
UNPACKING HOME BATTERY STORAGE & EV CHARGING; Is a home battery feasible for you? How does EV charging work? What's on offer with the new Federal Government's Battery Incentive? Come along to answer all your questions and debunk the myths. Participants are encouraged to bring along a recent copy of their energy bill and image of Meter box/Switchboard. Cost: \$10 RfR members \$15 non-members Café items available to purchase	26 July 10.30am-12.30pm MESA & RfR TEAM
DONT FLING IT, BLING IT; repurpose e-waste materials into wearable art using jewelry techniques and your imagination. Feel free to bring along something you would like to repair or repurpose. Tools & materials provided. Cost: \$65 RfR members \$75 non-members Light lunch Included	09 August 10am-2pm CARDOG DESIGNS

AUTOMATE; How to set up your own home automation server on a raspberry pi using Home Assistant Cost: \$40 RfR members \$50 non-members Light morning team Included	06 September 9.30-12.30 NICK BUCKMASTER
SHARPEST TOOL IN THE SHED; hands on workshop in power tool basics, perfect for beginners. Learn what's what in the shop and put it to use with a practical small build project. Tools & materials provided. Cost: \$60 RfR members \$70 non-members Light lunch Included	04 October 10am-2pm VIVIENNE WHITE
ALL THINGS SOLAR; grid connect, battery storage & off grid power supplies...figure it all out Cost: \$15 RfR members \$20 non-members Café items available to purchase	01 November 9.30am-12.30pm MESA & RfR TEAM

5. Sustainable kitchens workshop

· Batemans Bay Library — Tuesday 22 July, 2pm–3.30pm

· Narooma Library — Wednesday 30 July, 10.30am–12pm

Cost: free

Join in this hands-on workshop creating an all-natural cleaning product.

The heart of the home is the kitchen. This is where sustainability needs to be practical. Come along and learn how to reduce waste and embrace eco-friendly habits with simple, everyday changes.

Bookings are required

Places are limited for this event. To avoid disappointment, please book early online or contact your local library for assistance. For bookings and more information on these events, go to [What's on at the libraries | Eurobodalla Council](#).

7. Sustainable Swaps — Plants, toys and clothes!

Sunday 27 July 2025

10am–2pm

Where: Eurobodalla Regional Botanic Garden, Princes Highway, Batemans Bay

Cost: Free

Browse our 'one-stop swap shop' at Council's enviro-education trailer, where you'll have the chance to swap plants, clothing, and toys.

Plant swap

To take part in the plant swap, place environmental weeds from your garden in a bag and exchange them for free native plants. You can ask our environment team about weeds in your garden, learn about alternatives, and get great tips and advice.

Clothing swap

Swapping is also a clever and thrifty way to refresh your wardrobe, save money, and help fight textile waste. Your pre-loved clothes will find a new home and you'll leave with 'new' second-hand items for your wardrobe. To take part in our clothing swap, bring up to five items of clothing in excellent condition. Excellent condition means the clothing is clean, pressed and free from rips, holes, strains or major faults.

Toy swap

A toy swap is a fun way for children to exchange toys they no longer use. It also helps to reduce waste and promote sharing. To take part in the toy swap, bring along your toys in excellent condition. Excellent condition means gently used toys that are clean, undamaged, and in good working order.

(7a) Rainwater tank rebate now available to businesses, schools and residents of Eurobodalla Shire

If you've been considering buying a rainwater tank, now is the time. Whether it's your first, or you're adding a new one, Eurobodalla Shire Council is offering rebates from \$200 to \$600, depending on the size, and the number of connections. Rebates are offered for tanks which are used to water the garden, and/or are plumbed to toilets and washing machines.

Determining the size of tank

Tank size is a personal choice and will be influenced by your water usage, the size and shape of the intended tank location and your budget. For example, you may have a wide side passage, but a low eave overhanging the passage, preventing installation of a high, slim tank. Of course, you will also want to know how much water you might capture. To determine the right size rainwater tank, you'll need to consider your roof's catchment area, average rainfall, and water usage. A general rule of thumb is that each square meter of roof collects approximately 1 litre of water for every 1 millimetre of rainfall. You can then factor in your household's water consumption to estimate the tank size you need. Average rainfall in your area can be found on the Bureau of Meteorology website.

How much water does your household use?

Average water consumption across the Shire has been calculated to be around 173L per person, per day (source: the Water Conservancy). Installing your own tank reduces your reliance on the Shire's potable water supply, while giving you peace of mind in times of drought. You can purchase tanks with inbuilt bushfire reservoirs for even greater independence.

Checking your eligibility, and submitting an application

Please check your eligibility, and submit your application online with our rebate partner, Rebately: rebately.co/Eurobodalla

(8) SHASA networking

SHASA recently met with:

Federal Local Government and Emergency Management Minister, Kristy McBain

New ESC General Manager, Mark Ferguson

New ESC Sustainability Supervisor, Nina Bluebridge

Nature Conservation Council Climate Committee

The Eurobodalla Community Support Network

9. Tec Exec Disaster Preparedness Workshops flyer (Trish Pye)

10. Eurobodalla Community Support Network (photos of the last 2 meetings)

The Eurobodalla Community Support Network exists for individuals, community groups, service organisations and government agencies to connect, share and collaborate to increase community resilience in the Eurobodalla.

There are three ways to connect into the Network -

- 1. Come to a bi-monthly meeting where you get to share what's alive in your work in community, offer what you can, ask for what you need, hear from others.*
- 2. Have a yarn with Steph the coordinator so she can be an extra pair of ears and eyes for you and your organisation.*
- 3. Sign up and contribute to our newsletter with updates, requests, offerings and grant opportunities.*

Connect with the ECSN at eurobodalla.csn@gmail.com

SHASA has been an active member of this network since it was set up after the 2019/20 bushfires to facilitate improved communication by not-for-profits, service providers and government agencies on disaster preparedness and recovery.

(11) NSW solar feed-in tariffs - a slight increase

While feed-in tariffs have dropped significantly in recent years, there is good news in NSW. IPART (Independent Pricing and Regulatory Tribunal) has slightly increased the NSW feed-in tariff from 4.8c to 7.3c. Much better than Victoria, where it is nearly 0c.

Solar self-consumption is the best way for consumers to get the most value from their rooftop solar, because it reduces the amount of electricity bought from the grid. Batteries are the key to minimising exports and increasing self-consumption.

(12) Increased interest in energy-efficient houses

Energy-efficient houses are a "must-have" for a growing number of buyers, commanding a premium price in markets across the country, property experts say.

The demand is reflected in real estate advertising, with half the homes currently for sale touting some sort of energy-efficient feature, according to a new report from the property website, Domain.

North-facing homes, double-glazed windows and solar panels are all attractive features that offer year-round comfort as well as smaller energy bills, the report says.

Domain's chief of research, Nicola Powell, said much of that demand is being pushed by "middle Australia", especially with [energy prices set to rise for half a million homes and businesses across the country from July](#).

(13) Our transition to renewable energy is changing

The NSW Government has announced it wants to create the first ["urban" renewable-energy zone in the Illawarra](#). NSW Energy Minister Penny Sharpe says the urban REZ will focus on rooftop solar, including on the rooftops of industry, installing home and community batteries, supporting the uptake of EVs and moulding them to be a cheap, reliable and low emissions source of power.

"So it's not just about the individuals who can afford it, it's about stabilising the grid. It's about driving down costs, because we're not wasting any of the solar energy... so it's a pretty exciting change."

The more households that install solar and batteries, the less we need new transmission lines.

14. Successful EuroBEV lunch

at Grumpy and Sweetheart's Cafe, Mogo, Sunday 1 June. Weather — glorious. Company — engaging



Above: Rob Shorrock, Suzanne Shorrock, Kathryn Maxwell, Charlie Bell and George Cook enjoying their lunch.

Below: And in the parking lot, with their EVs: Helen Walster (MG S5), Andrew Everard (2018 Nissan Leaf), Arno Schaaf (BYD Atto 3), Steve Young (Kia EV5), George Cook (Chery OMODA) Peter Haughton (BYD Atto3) Charlie Bell (Kia EV3)

Tile for the EuroBEV lunch at the Catalina Club 27 July 12 noon



EV Mini-Expo, Narooma, 22 June — 12 cars, beautiful weather, and lots of serious interest from market visitors

Tile for the Moruya EV Mini Expo 4 October 2025

Look for the next EV Mini-Expo in Moruya 4 October, the Saturday of the October long weekend.



15. BATEMANS BAY EV FAST DC CHARGERS, JUNE 2025

Question: How many EVs can fast-charge at once in the Batemans Bay area?

Answer: It depends!

I am aware of four lots of fast DC chargers in the vicinity of Batemans Bay township. They are at the Bay Pavilions (3CCS2 and 1 ChaDeMo), the Village Shopping Centre (4 CCS2), the Catalina Country Club (4 Tesla/CCS2) and Dan Murphy's Liquor Store(2 CCS2).

Where a charger has a pair of CCS2 cables, both can be plugged in at the same time, but each charging car will be able to use half of the available power, and therefore will charge more slowly than if only one is connected. Where a charger has one ChaDeMo cable and one CCS2 cable, only one car at a time can charge. The first car to plug in will charge until it stops, then the second car can begin.

So, at the Pavilions, up to three cars can charge at once, at the Village, four, Dan Murphy's two and the Country club, six. Theoretically, fifteen EVs can be charging all at the same time.

If you know of more, please let us know.

(16) More than half of Australians wrongly believe EVs are more likely to catch fire, survey shows

Findings highlight how misinformation about battery safety prevents drivers from investing in low-emission cars

Australian Associated Press

Tue 10 Jun 2025

More than a third of Australians believe misinformation about [electric vehicles](#), while almost half accept the myth that battery-powered cars are more likely to catch fire, a study shows.

Researchers from the University of Queensland and three German institutions released the findings after surveys of more than 6,300 people in Australia, the US, Germany and Austria. Their results mirrored concerns in an NRMA study that found misinformation about battery safety was preventing motorists from investing in low-emission cars.

Incorrect statements that EVs were more likely to catch fire than petrol or diesel cars gained the highest acceptance from Australians surveyed (47%), while 44% also believed EV batteries were deliberately non-upgradeable.

Other claims about manufacturing outweighing the lower emissions of electric cars (35%) and EV accidents being under-reported (26%) were also concerning, the University of Queensland environmental psychologist and co-author, Dr Chris Bretter said.

"The misinformation statements we tested included that EVs are more likely to catch fire than petrol cars, do not produce emission savings and emit electromagnetic fields that damage health – all claims which are demonstrably false," Bretter said.

Participants also had their perceptions tested after a three-round conversation about electric vehicles with OpenAI's ChatGPT and after reading a US Department of Energy fact

sheet debunking claims. Both interventions delivered “modest increases in pro-EV sentiment”, the study found.

“Given the global need to transition toward more sustainable transport options, it is crucial we address the prevalence of misinformation about energy-efficient technologies like EVs,” he said.

The findings come days after NRMA released a report, prepared by Ipsos, that found two in three Australians remained concerned about electric vehicle battery fires and safety despite low incident reports.

17. Deakin University Study — explores how households and small businesses can better use solar energy

We’re reaching out to you as fellow advocates for a fully electrified and sustainable future. Many of your local communities are already leading the charge — and we believe they could play a valuable role in helping to shape the future of Australia’s energy system through an exciting new research initiative.

Deakin University, with funding from Energy Consumers Australia, is conducting a study titled: “The Benefits of Hyper-Utilisation of Consumer Energy Resources (CERs) through a Virtual Energy Network (VEN)”

This research explores how households and small businesses can better utilise solar energy — including how those without their own solar systems can benefit from surplus solar energy generated by others through a Virtual Energy Network (VEN).

We would be grateful if you could share this opportunity with your network members and friends.

Who is eligible to participate?

You need to meet at least one of the following criteria:

- be a household or small business with solar panels, looking to maximise the use of locally generated energy
- be a household or small business without solar, but interested in accessing surplus local solar energy
- have a specific energy consumer you would like to share your excess solar with (including other properties you may own)

and

- have a smart meter installed
- be (or be willing to become) an Energy Locals customer, the retail partner enabling participation in the Virtual Energy Network

This is a unique opportunity to help shape a more equitable, community-powered energy future — with practical benefits for both solar owners and those who don't yet have access to it.

If any of your group or their friends are interested in participating and/or would like more information, please direct them to the Deakin Website via this link -

<https://loom.ly/rAlqKg0>.

They might also like to have a look at this short VEN explainer video that WinZero has prepared as part of our contribution to the project -

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xn_UhQSDy84

Kind regards

Derek White, Secretary - WinZero Inc (Registered Charity with DGR1 Status)

Ph: 0411 703 745

18. Members meeting tile

19. SHASA 2025/26 memberships due

Reminder membership fee of \$5 is due for the 2025/26 financial year. You can join and/or renew your membership on the SHASA website <https://shasa.com.au/membership-and-donations/>

As a member, you can attend our regular members' meetings to have your say about what's important to you, and you are covered by SHASA's insurance when involved in any of SHASA's activities — all for only \$5 p.a.

20. Summary of what's on

Event	Details
RfR Weaving from Waste	19 July 10am - 2pm
	RfR Community Solar Reuse Centre,
	Moruya Transfer Station
Be Ready Eurobodalla Tech Talk	Monday 21 July 10am - 12noon
	Narooma Golf Club
ESC Sustainable Kitchen Workshop	Tuesday 22 July 2pm -3.30pm
	Batemans Bay Library
Be Ready Eurobodalla Tech Talk	Tuesday 22 July 10am - 12noon
	Bay Pavillions

Be Ready Eurobodalla Tech Talk	Thursday 24 July 10am - 12noon
	Moruya Golf Club

RfR Information session battery rebate	Saturday 26 July 10.30am - 12.30pm
	RfR Community Solar Reuse Centre
	Moruya Transfer Station

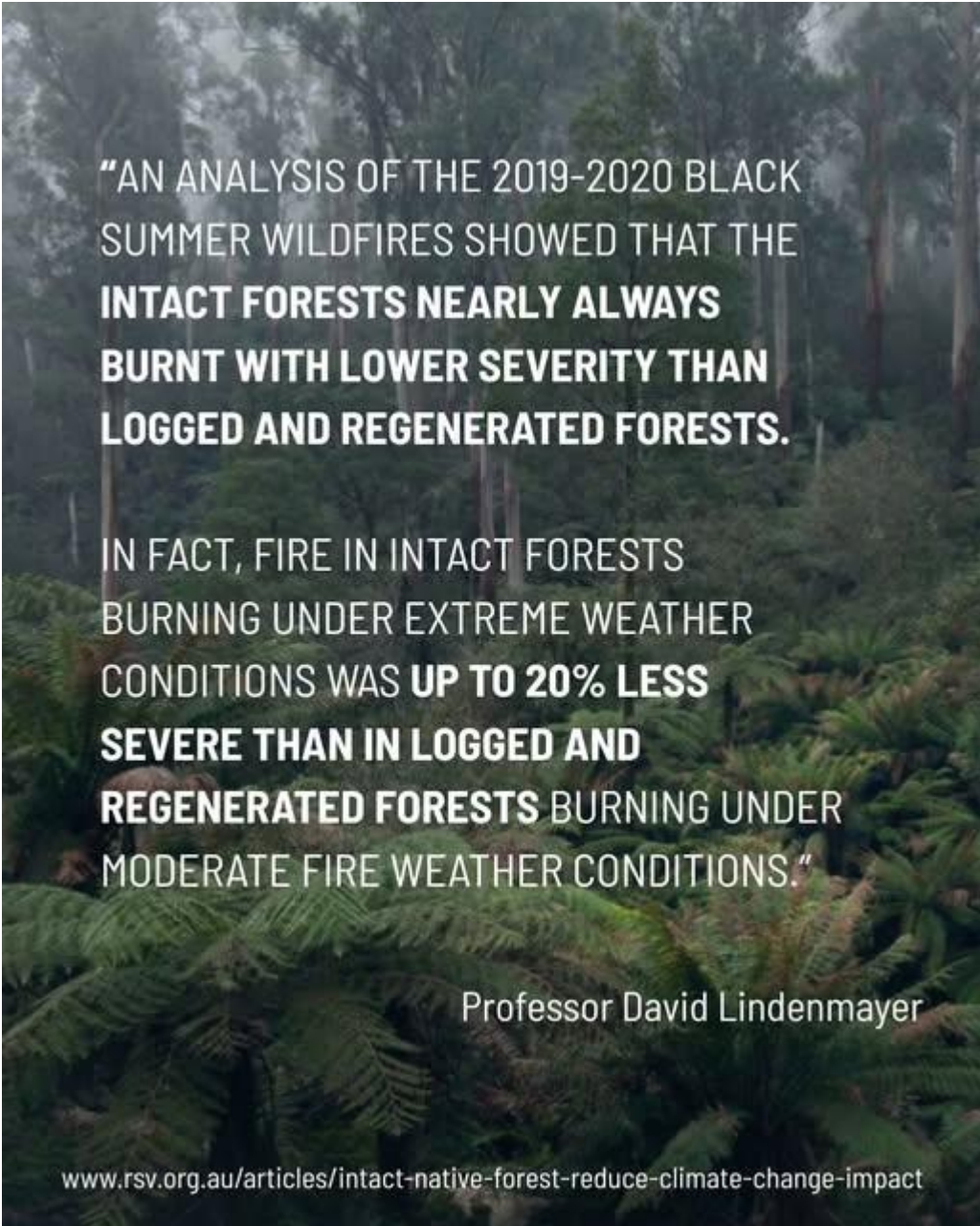
Sustainable Swaps - plants, toys, clothes	Sunday 27 July 10am - 12pm
	Eurobodalla Botanic Gardens

SHASA EuroBEV lunch	Sunday 27 July 12 noon- 2pm
	Catalina Club

ESC Sustainable Kitchen Workshop	Wednesday 30 July 10.30am - 12pm
	Narooma Library

RfR Dont fling it, bling it	Saturday 9 August 10am - 2pm
Repurpose E waste into jewelry	RfR Community Solar Reuse Centre
	Moruya Transfer Station

SHASA Moruya EV Mini Expo	Saturday 4 October 8am - 1pm
	Moruya Markets



"AN ANALYSIS OF THE 2019-2020 BLACK
SUMMER WILDFIRES SHOWED THAT THE
**INTACT FORESTS NEARLY ALWAYS
BURNT WITH LOWER SEVERITY THAN
LOGGED AND REGENERATED FORESTS.**

IN FACT, FIRE IN INTACT FORESTS
BURNING UNDER EXTREME WEATHER
CONDITIONS WAS **UP TO 20% LESS
SEVERE THAN IN LOGGED AND
REGENERATED FORESTS** BURNING UNDER
MODERATE FIRE WEATHER CONDITIONS."

Professor David Lindenmayer

www.rsv.org.au/articles/intact-native-forest-reduce-climate-change-impact

